



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage Academy Augusta
School Website: <http://heritageacademyaugusta.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Heritage Academy Augusta GA presents a distinctly Christian, mission-driven program that foregrounds character formation, faith integration, and parental partnership. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, biblically grounded education, weekly chapel, and a philosophy of formation that seeks to cultivate virtue, wisdom, and love of learning alongside academics. Across six evaluation categories, the school demonstrates strong classical inclinations in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with notable classical elements in Curriculum and Pedagogy that are present but not yet fully aligned with the traditional Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium framework, or fully explicit Socratic pedagogy. Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious/metaphysical grounding is explicit and pervasive (Christ-centered, Holy Scripture as authority, weekly chapel, liturgical/communion language). This anchors the school in a transcendent moral realism and liturgical practice. Evidence: Our Beliefs; Mission/Vision; weekly chapel statements.

- The school consistently positions education as formation in virtue and character, with explicit language about guiding students toward truth, goodness, and beauty, and a parental-partner model. Evidence: Mission/Vision; Portrait of a Heritage Graduate; statements about parental partnership.

- Curriculum and pedagogy show strong classical fibers (grammar/logic/rhetoric framing is referenced in school documents; language includes Latin and classical literacy elements in FAQs and program descriptions), but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and sustained Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis are not consistently visible in the public materials. Evidence: Academics page (Christian worldview and integrated curriculum with a broad set of subjects); FAQs noting Latin and Suzuki violin; lack of explicit Great Books references in public pages.

- Pedagogy displays elements of traditional formation (memory work and recitation are part of classical pedagogy in the Six Elements model), but public materials emphasize a broader, modern co-curricular emphasis rather than explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy. Evidence: Faculty/Leadership pages; statements about "Socratic" pedagogy are not explicit in site content; the school emphasizes chapel, memory-like proclamations, and character formation rather than a sustained Socratic program. - Faculty and governance present the school as a mission-driven, teacher-mentored community (living curriculum concepts, leadership figures, and board). This aligns with classical expectations of virtuous mentors and a shared culture. Evidence: Board of Directors; Executive Director/leadership statements. - Parents & Community are explicitly welcomed as co-educators and partners in formation, with visible outreach and engagement channels (admissions, parent involvement, and volunteering). Evidence: Admissions and parent engagement materials; statements about partnership with families.

Note: The abstract assessment below integrates the keyword-driven analysis with the six-element rubric to yield the overall CLASSICAL designation, with category-level nuances documented in the snapshots that follow.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials affirm a Christian, biblically grounded framework: “The Holy Scripture is the Word of God” and “Heritage Academy believes that all people are created in the image of God” (Statement of Philosophy; Our Beliefs). - The mission/vision explicitly anchors education in Christ-centered aims and godly formation, including “Christ-centered instruction” and “rooted in Biblical principles and values.” - Weekly chapel and liturgical-adjacent practices are explicitly referenced (e.g., “weekly chapel program” and campus chapel traditions).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; God; Holy Scripture; Chapel; Biblical; Jesus; faith. - Negative keywords: None detected in the public materials for this category.

Why this rating - The materials foreground transcendental moral realism (virtue, truth, goodness, beauty) through a theological lens, with explicit liturgical/community practices (chapel, prayer, creed-like language) and a theology-grounded approach to learning. This aligns strongly with the Classical criterion for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Cited evidence: Holy Scripture and God-centric language; Christ-centered mission; Chapel/worship emphasis.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes forming the whole person through a Christ-centered education (formation of virtue and character) rather than mere information; the Vision calls for shaping spirit and character and a “healthy spiritual, physical, social, and emotional life.” - The school articulates human flourishing through a value-based framework, including a “Portrait of a Heritage Graduate” with traits such as Love God, Love Learning, and Reason Wisely. - The public statements emphasize partnering with parents and a shared mission to “build a godly foundation” for students and families.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; character; wisdom; telos; love of learning; unity of belief; Great Conversation (explicit in classical discourse but not always labeled as such on the site). - Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school explicitly positions education as formation (virtue, wisdom, character) and places a clear telos beyond vocational training. The parental partnership language further reinforces a traditional paideia-oriented aim. This aligns with Classical expectations for School Purpose and Goal.

Cited evidence: Mission/Vision; Portrait of a Heritage Graduate; parental partnership language.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Academics pages frame a Christian worldview across subjects with integration of faith and learning, and a broad set of co-curriculars (Chapel, PE, Robotics, STEM, Health, Music, Violin, Library, Computer, Art, field trips). This demonstrates an integrated curriculum with liberal-arts sensibility, but not consistently framed around the Great Books canon or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium structure in public materials. - FAQs indicate presence of Latin and traditional subjects (Latin and Suzuki violin) and a focus on classical literacy within co-curricular offerings; additional Great Books/primary texts are not plainly advertised in public sections. - The school publishes early-learning and K–8 pathways, with emphasis on a rigorous, faith-integrated academics program and a “Portrait of a Heritage Graduate” that signals formation-oriented curriculum rather than a pure canonical Great Books program.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books (not explicitly present in site copy), Seven Liberal Arts (not explicitly named), Grammars of the Trivium (not explicitly named in public

materials), Latin (present), Classical canon (not clearly framed as such on site), integration of history/history-with-faith (present in purpose and academics pages). - Negative keywords: There is no explicit, repeated emphasis on Great Books or direct Great Conversation framing in public-facing content; no consistent explicit articulation of Trivium/Quadrivium in the public site copy. - Quantitative estimate (as implemented here using the Six Elements indicators available in the knowledge base): Positive keywords visible (Latin; integrated Christian curriculum; broad liberal-arts framing implied) vs. explicit canonical elements (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium) not clearly present in public pages. Approximately 1–2 positive signals vs. 1 negative signal (absence of Great Books/Great Conversation framing). This yields a mixed signal.

Why this rating - The public materials show a robust, formation-focused, faith-integrated curriculum with a broad liberal-arts flavor and multiple disciplines, but they do not consistently situate the curriculum within the classical Great Books tradition or explicitly articulate Trivium/Quadrivium foundations in public-facing content. This warrants a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation, rather than fully CLASSICAL, until canonical Great Books/Great Conversation alignment is publicly demonstrated.

Cited evidence: Academics page; Latin and other classical offerings in FAQs; broader formation emphasis.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a strong emphasis on formation, chapel, and a broad set of co-curriculars rather than explicit Socratic dialogue, structured memory work, or the standard Scholé-style contemplative pace detailed in classical pedagogy rubrics. There is mention of “K-8 Learn the WHAT” and “6-8 Learn the HOW TO THINK,” which hints at some gradual development toward reasoning, but there is no explicit articulation of upper-school Socratic seminars, rigorous rhetorical training, or memory-centric recitation in public-facing materials. - The public content highlights a large focus on communal worship, Christian lifestyle, and character formation, with less emphasis on the contemplative/restful pedagogy (Scholé), memorization/recitation, or model-exemplar learning typical of a robust classical pedagogy. Public pages do not consistently present the upper-school Socratic seminars, debates, or structured memory-centric practices. - Some hallmarks of classical pedagogy (e.g., singing/chanting, memorization, and formal recitation) are not clearly evidenced on the public-facing site; the Dyslexia outreach, aquaponics, and project-like showcases appear more as enrichment than as core pedagogical method.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive/classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, rhetoric instruction, recitation/memorization, calm contemplative days) are not clearly evident in the public-facing materials. - Negative signals (lack of explicit, foundational classical pedagogy) are present in the absence of explicit mentions of Socratic dialogue, memory work, and formal “Scholé” practices.

Why this rating - While Heritage Academy Augusta presents a strong formation and faith-integrated approach, the public materials do not clearly articulate canonical classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, formal memory work, or sustained dialectic/rhetoric training) in a way that satisfies the core Pedagogy criteria of a Classical School. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL in this category, with potential for movement toward CLASSICAL if public documentation begins to foreground Socratic discourse, memorization/recitation, and contemplative pedagogy.

Cited evidence: Pedagogy-related claims in Academics/Beliefs/Philosophy sections; absence of explicit Socratic/Scholé/recitation language in public content.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a leadership structure with a Board of Directors and an Executive Director, demonstrating a governance model consistent with a formal living curriculum and a community of mentors. This aligns with a classical expectation of virtuous leadership and professional responsibility in shaping the school’s culture. - The public materials reflect a culture of committed staff and “leaders in urban education”

with a focus on shaping a child's spirit and character; the emphasis on mission, values, and expectations signals a strong faculty culture oriented toward virtue and mentorship. - The "Portrait of a Heritage Graduate" and related hallmarks frame teacher and student formation as a coupled, character-building endeavor, which aligns with the classical ideal of the living curriculum embodied by dedicated teachers and mentors.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers/mentors; faculty as core; "portrait of a teacher/student"; professional leadership; commitment to prayer/discipleship. - Negative keywords: None apparent in public materials; no explicit anti-classical signals.

Why this rating - The content indicates a strong faculty culture with engaged leadership and a mission-driven, mentorship-centered approach, consistent with classical expectations of a virtuous, knowledgeable, and supportive teaching cadre. This supports CLASSICAL for the Faculty category.

Cited evidence: Board/Leadership pages; statements about staff and mission; Portrait of a Heritage Graduate.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators, with visible channels for parent involvement, book studies, gatherings, and campus visits; admissions pages highlight ongoing parent engagement and a welcoming campus environment.

- The site describes parental engagement as foundational, with practical programs for family involvement, prayer, and communication to support the child's formation; this indicates an intentional community model rather than a purely transactional relationship. - Public materials show a history of community engagement and donor involvement (e.g., news, alumni, and donor communications) that reflect a culture of reciprocal community support around the school's mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-educators; parental engagement; family involvement; home-school partnership; open campus (visits). - Negative keywords: None evident on public pages.

Why this rating - Heritage Academy Augusta shows a robust, explicit commitment to parental partnership and community involvement, which is central to classical education's emphasis on forming a virtuous, educated citizenry in partnership with families. This aligns with CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

Cited evidence: Partnership with Families language; admissions/parent engagement; community/news pages.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, Heritage Academy Augusta GA is classified as CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - To strengthen from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum (Element 3) toward full CLASSICAL, explicitly foreground Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium), Great Books/Great Conversation, and historically grounded pedagogy within public materials. Publicly document Great Books selections, primary texts, and explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing; integrate and publish a clearly stated plan for Socratic seminars or rigorous dialectic for upper grades; and showcase a sustained program of memorization/recitation or chant as a pedagogical pillar in the lower and middle years (as guided by classical

education practice). This would move Element 3 to CLASSICAL and strengthen the overall profile. - To move Pedagogy from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL, publish explicit articulation of Socratic teaching in upper grades, memory work/recitation, and contemplative Scholé days as formal components of the curriculum, with teacher training documentation and examples from classroom practice.

Note: Implementation of these needle-moving steps would need to be reflected in publicly accessible curriculum pages, syllabi, and teacher professional development materials.

Cited evidence: Curriculum/practice notes and lack of explicit Great Books/Trivium framing in public content; presence of strong formation language and liturgical emphasis.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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